

AZ-900 Mini Project Report

Creating My First Virtual Machine in Microsoft Azure

Objective

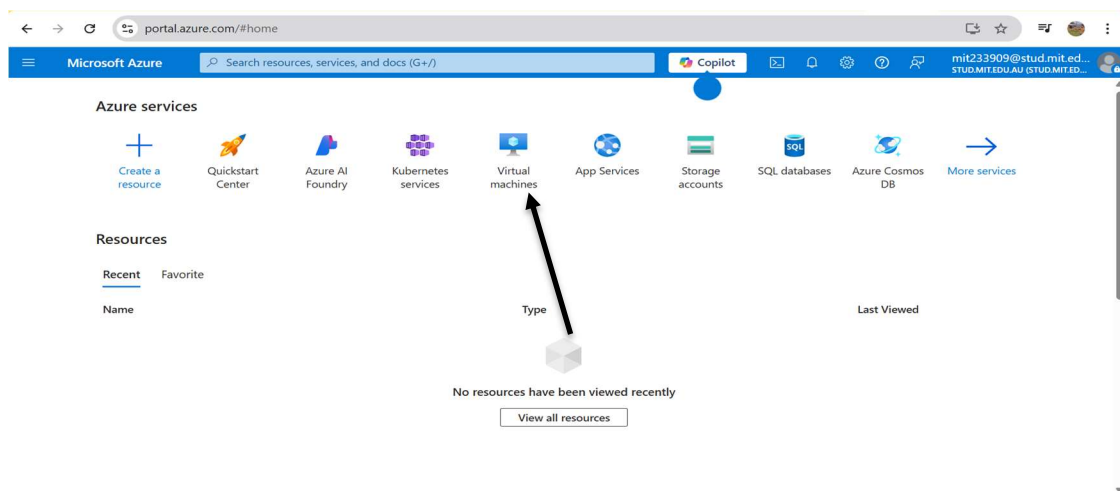
The goal of this mini lab is to create and configure a basic virtual machine (VM) in the Microsoft Azure portal, with a focus on understanding key provisioning steps such as selecting region, image, resource group, and validating web access via IIS.

Steps Performed

☒ Step 1: Sign into Azure Portal

Logged into the Azure Portal (<https://portal.azure.com>).

Navigated to the Virtual Machines service via the sidebar or search bar ('VM', 'Virtual Machine').



☒ Step 2: Start VM Creation

Clicked the Create button and selected Virtual Machine.

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure portal interface for managing virtual machines. The top navigation bar includes the Azure logo, a search bar, and user information. The left sidebar shows the 'Virtual machines' section under 'Compute infrastructure'. The main content area displays a message 'No virtual machines to display' and a 'Create' button. A dropdown menu is open, showing options: 'Virtual machine', 'Virtual machine scale set (VMSS)', 'Presets', and 'Hybrid, preconfigured, and high volume solutions'. An arrow points from the 'Create' button in the main view to the 'Virtual machine' option in the dropdown.

✓ Step 3: Configure Basic Settings

- Resource Group: Created a new group called 'MyVmRG'.
- VM Name: Set to 'MyFirstVM'.
- Region: Chose Australia East (closest to my location in Sydney).
- Image: Selected Windows Server 2019 Datacenter – Gen2.
- Inbound Ports: Enabled RDP (3389), HTTP (80), HTTPS (443).

Basics

Subscription	Azure for Students
Resource group	(new) MyVmRG
Virtual machine name	MyfirstVM
Region	Australia East
Availability options	No infrastructure redundancy required
Zone options	Self-selected zone
Security type	Standard
Image	Windows Server 2019 Datacenter - Gen2
VM architecture	x64
Size	Standard D2s v3 (2 vcpus, 8 GiB memory)
Enable Hibernation	No
Username	AzureUser
Public inbound ports	RDP, HTTPS, HTTP
Already have a Windows license?	No
Azure Spot	No

Disks

OS disk size	Image default
OS disk type	Premium SSD LRS
Use managed disks	Yes
Delete OS disk with VM	Enabled
Ephemeral OS disk	No

Networking

Virtual network	(new) MyfirstVM-vnet
Subnet	(new) default (10.0.0.0/24)
Public IP	(new) MyfirstVM-ip
Accelerated networking	Off
Place this virtual machine behind an existing load balancing solution?	No
Delete public IP and NIC when VM is deleted	Disabled

Management

Microsoft Defender for Cloud	None
System assigned managed identity	Off
Login with Microsoft Entra ID	Off
Auto-shutdown	Off
Enable periodic assessment	Off
Enable hotpatch	Off
Patch orchestration options	OS-orchestrated patching: patches will be installed by OS

Monitoring

Alerts	Off
Boot diagnostics	Off
Enable OS guest diagnostics	Off
Enable application health monitoring	Off

☑ Step 4: Review + Create

Clicked Review + Create.

Deployment succeeded.

Navigated to the VM's Resource Overview page to view system properties and status.

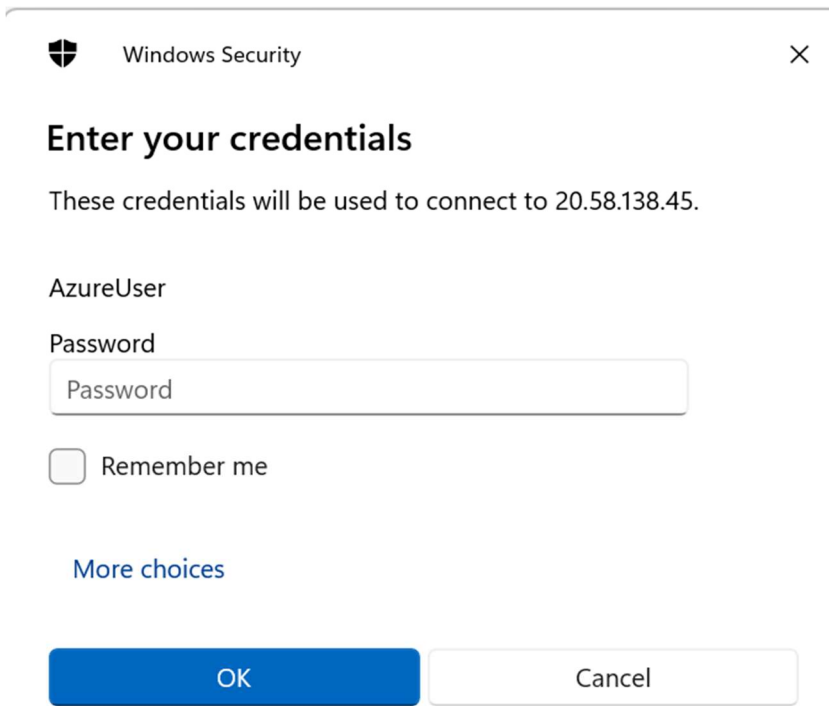
The screenshot displays the Azure portal interface. At the top, a navigation bar includes icons for 'Connect', 'Start', 'Restart', 'Stop', 'Hibernate', 'Capture', 'Delete', 'Refresh', 'Open in mobile', 'Feedback', and 'CLI / PS'. Below this, the 'Essentials' section provides key information about the virtual machine: Resource group (MyVmRG), Status (Running), Location (Australia East), Subscription (Azure for Students), and Subscription ID (9e555222-0a50-42e5-9a8f-2ad2b799787e). To the right, system properties are listed: Operating system (Windows (Windows Server 2019 Datacenter)), Size (Standard D2s v3 (2 vcpus, 8 GiB memory)), Public IP address (20.58.138.45), Virtual network/subnet (MyfirstVM-vnet/default), DNS name (Not configured), Health state (-), and Time created (7/8/2025, 1:43 PM UTC).

Below the Essentials section, the 'MyfirstVM | Connect' blade is open. It shows a search bar, a 'Refresh' button, and a 'Troubleshoot' dropdown. The 'Connect' section is active, displaying 'Connecting using Public IP address | 20.58.138.45'. It lists the Admin username (AzureUser), Port (3389), and Just-in-time policy (Unsupported by plan). A 'Most common' section highlights 'Native RDP' as the recommended connection method, with a 'Select' button and a 'Download RDP file' button. A 'More ways to connect (4)' section is also visible.

✓ Step 5: Connect to VM

Used the Connect button to download the RDP file.

Launched Remote Desktop and successfully connected to the virtual machine.



Windows Security

Enter your credentials

These credentials will be used to connect to 20.58.138.45.

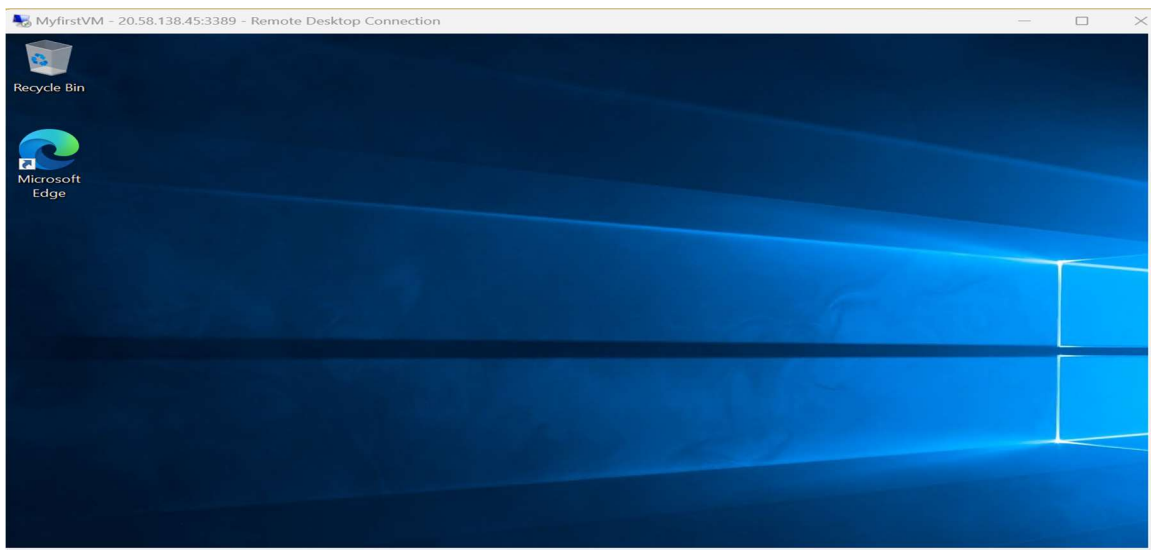
AzureUser

Password

☐ Remember me

[More choices](#)

OK Cancel



✓ Step 6: Verify Web Access (IIS Test)

Ran the following PowerShell command on the VM to install IIS:

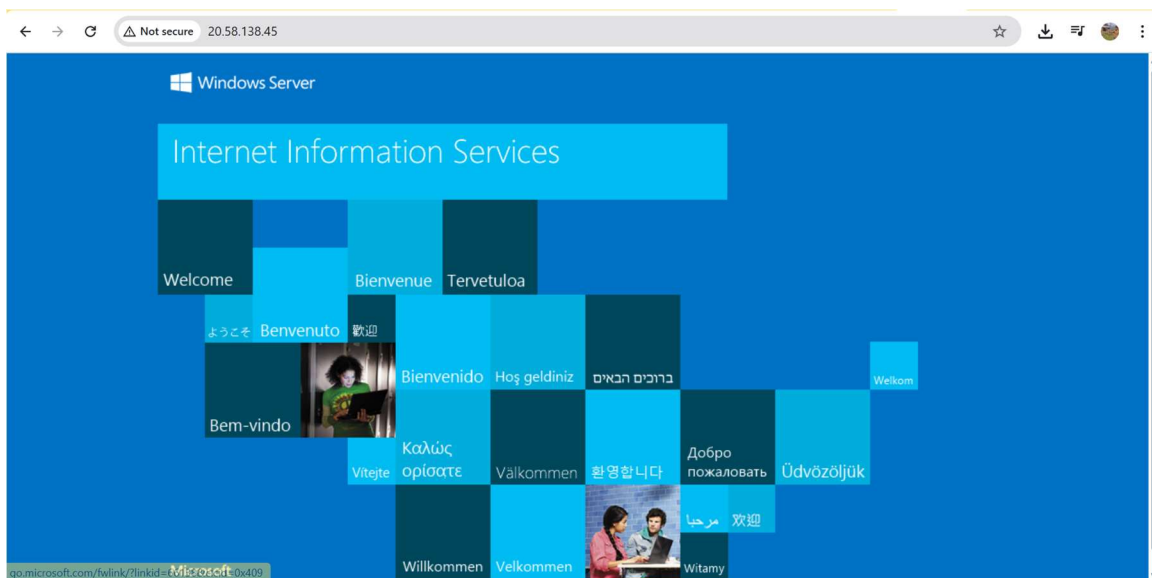
```
Administrator: Windows PowerShell
Windows PowerShell
Copyright (C) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

PS C:\Users\AzureUser> Install-WindowsFeature -name Web-Server -IncludeManagementTools

Success Restart Needed Exit Code      Feature Result
-----
True      No          Success      {Common HTTP Features, Default Document, D...

PS C:\Users\AzureUser>
```

Copied the public IP address of the VM, opened it in a browser.
Verified the IIS default welcome page loaded successfully.



What I Learned

- How to deploy and connect to a Windows VM in Azure.
- Importance of selecting the correct region for latency and cost optimization.
- How to enable and verify inbound traffic for services like RDP and HTTP.
- How to use PowerShell to configure a basic web server (IIS).

